SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #102 · GOD'S WILL & GUIDANCE

"God's will is always the thing I least want."

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Where it often comes from

Fear that God will send you somewhere you dread if you surrender to Him. Teaching that emphasized sacrifice without joy. A parent who withheld good things. Assuming that if you want something, it must be selfish. Picturing God as a stern boss rather than a loving Father.

What Scripture teaches

God's will sometimes involves hard things, and following Jesus includes sacrifice. But God is not looking for ways to make you miserable. Jesus said that if earthly parents give good gifts, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask. God's will is good, pleasing, and perfect. As you delight in the LORD, He shapes your desires and gives you the desires of your heart. His plans for His people include hope and a future.

> *"Which of you, if his son asks for bread, will give him a stone? Or if he asks for a fish, will give him a snake? So if you who are evil know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!"* **(Matthew 7:9–11)**.

Also see

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" **(Romans 12:2)**.

> "Delight yourself in the LORD, and He will give you the desires of your heart" **(Psalm 37:4)**.

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" **(Jeremiah 29:11)**.

> "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand" **(Psalm 16:11)**.

Common self-statements

- If I want it, God probably doesn't.
- God will make me do what I hate.
- Surrendering to God means losing everything I love.
- God's plan is always the hardest path.
- My desires don't matter to God.
- God likes to make me uncomfortable.

Common logical errors

- **Projection:** Picturing God as a stern or withholding authority figure.
- **Overgeneralization:** Turning "God's will is sometimes hard" into "it's always what I least want."
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking God's goodness and the joy of following Him.
- **Fear-based thinking:** Avoiding surrender because you fear God's plans.

Challenging questions

- Would a loving father give his child a stone instead of bread?
- How does Romans 12:2 describe God's will?
- What happens to my desires as I delight in the LORD?
- Has God ever given me something good that I wanted?
- Am I picturing God like someone from my past?
- Is it possible God put some of my desires in me?
- What would it look like to trust God's goodness with my plans?

Truth summary

> God's will is not always the thing I least want. My Father in heaven gives good gifts. His will is good, pleasing, and perfect. Sometimes it includes hard things, but always for my good. As I delight in Him, He shapes my desires and gives me the desires of my heart.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Love, By God
- Trust
- Joy
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Prayer

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God's will is always the thing I least want"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God's will is always the thing I least want." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Would a loving father give a stone for bread?
- ☐ How is God's will described?
- ☐ What happens to my desires as I delight in God?
- ☐ Has God given me good things I wanted?
- ☐ Am I picturing God like someone from my past?
- ☐ Did God put some desires in me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My Father gives good gifts.
- ☐ God's will is good, pleasing, and perfect.
- ☐ As I delight in God, He shapes my desires.
- ☐ God's plans for me include hope.
- ☐ Hard things in God's will are for my good.
- ☐ In God's presence there is joy.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Matthew 7:9–11**
  "Which of you, if his son asks for bread, will give him a stone? Or if he asks for a fish, will give him a snake? So if you who are evil know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!"
- [ ] **Romans 12:2**
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."
- [ ] **Psalm 37:4**
  "Delight yourself in the LORD, and He will give you the desires of your heart."
- [ ] **Jeremiah 29:11**
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- [ ] **Psalm 16:11**
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Good gifts log:** Each day, write one good gift God gave me that I wanted or enjoyed.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 37:4 becomes: "**Sarah** can delight **herself** in the LORD, and He will give **her** the desires of **her** heart."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write a list of good things God has given you** that you once wanted.
- ☐ **Tell God honestly what you want,** and ask Him to shape your desires.
- ☐ **Read Matthew 7:7–11,** and write what it says about your Father's heart.
- ☐ **Talk with a mature believer** about a time God's will turned out better than they expected.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God's will is always the thing I least want": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One good gift I received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God's will is always the thing I least want.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You give good gifts to Your children. Help me reject the lie that Your will is always the thing I least want. Teach me to delight in You, to trust Your goodness, and to believe that Your will is good, pleasing, and perfect. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.